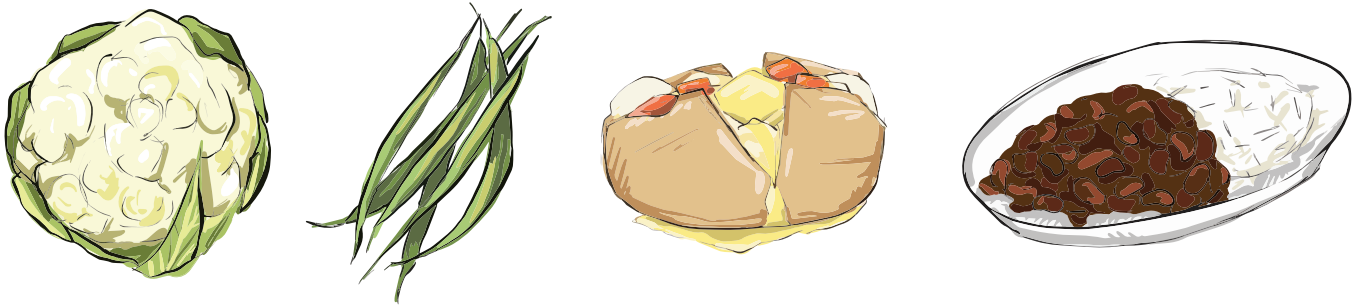


CARBOHYDRATES



The two main sources of food energy are carbs and fats. We talk about carbs today because they are an immediate and very easily broken down source of energy which our bodies prefer and will use up first. All carbs are broken down to sugar. It does not matter if it is a “good or complex” carb like brown rice or a “bad or simple” carb like white bread because the end result is the same: a rise in our blood sugar which signals our body to secrete insulin which is a fat storing hormone. Secretion of insulin leads to weight gain with an increase in cravings and feelings of fatigue along the way!

Burning fat for fuel instead of carbohydrates is more work for your body but is a more sustained energy source. This can only be accomplished when sugar is not an available energy source. We will discuss fats next week.

Everyone’s body has a threshold for carbohydrates before things become overloaded and we store fat. We will work together to figure out your level of carbohydrate reduction.

COUNTING CARBOHYDRATES

Learning the skill of counting carbs will lead to more consistent weight loss and weight maintenance. Your starting carb number is _____g carbohydrates. This carb target will change as your body changes.

READING LABELS

Food packaging can be deceiving. Reading the nutrition facts label will allow you to get past the marketing and merchandizing.

Nutrition Facts	
8 servings per container	
Serving size	2/3 cup (55g)
Amount per 2/3 cup	
Calories	230
% DV*	
12%	Total Fat 8g
5%	Saturated Fat 1g
	Trans Fat 0g
0%	Cholesterol 0mg
7%	Sodium 160mg
12%	Total Carbs 37g
14%	Dietary Fiber 4g
	Sugars 1g
	Added Sugars 0g
	Protein 3g
10%	Vitamin D 2mcg
20%	Calcium 260mg
45%	Iron 8mg
5%	Potassium 235mg
* Footnote on Daily Values (DV) and calories reference to be inserted here.	

Net Carbohydrates

Since your body does not absorb fiber, it will not cause an insulin increase, so subtract from the total carbohydrates. No additional math needs to be done for the grams of sugar, added sugar, or sugar alcohols when present, as these are already accounted for in the total!

Total Carb - Dietary Fiber = Net Carb

Example on left:

37g Total Carb - 4g Fiber = 33g Net Carb